

Kaala Bandar

The city of Delhi alone has registered close to 5000 mobile phone robberies in the past year

Cloud services you may want to try

Sprite Migrate: <http://goo.gl/Lugm>

Mobical: <http://goo.gl/tOQG>

Dashwire: <http://goo.gl/Zqd0>

	Symbian S60	Android	Windows Mobile	Blackberry
We recommend	Guardian Mobile	Theft Aware	RemoteTracker	PhoneBAK Anti Theft
URL	http://goo.gl/8QGD	http://goo.gl/t5GA	http://goo.gl/cx7p	http://goo.gl/nkaJ
Cost	Free	Eur 9.99	Free	\$9.90
Features				
SIM change Notification	Y	Y	Y	Y
100% Invisible	N	Y	Y	N
Remote Lock	N	Y	Y	Y
Remote Data Wipe	N	Y	Y	Y
GPS Tracking	N	Y	Y	Y
Siren	N	Y	Y	N
Multi SIM support	N	Y	Y	Y
Notes	Gold and Platinum available with most features available	Free trial version expires in 3 days, Many free alternatives	Many more features available as well	Free trial version expires in 30 days
Other apps available				
Name	Theft Aware	Anti Theft Lite	GuardMobile	Roblock
URL	http://goo.gl/t5GA	http://goo.gl/XF50	http://goo.gl/m2Es	http://goo.gl/NNLQ
Name	F-Secure Anti Theft	F-Secure Anti Theft	F-Secure Anti Theft	Berry Locator
URL	http://goo.gl/FO8T	http://goo.gl/FO8T	http://goo.gl/FO8T	http://goo.gl/BOns
Name	SecureMe S60	ATF Lock	RecoveryCop	Getitback
URL	http://goo.gl/RJcK	http://goo.gl/JrmJ	http://goo.gl/CuRo	http://goo.gl/0pi6
Name	SmrtGuard	SmrtGuard	mSafe	SmrtGuard
URL	http://goo.gl/iq8n	http://goo.gl/iq8n	http://goo.gl/byqu	http://goo.gl/iq8n
Name	WaveSecure	WaveSecure	WaveSecure	WaveSecure
URL	http://goo.gl/Ts4c	http://goo.gl/Ts4c	http://goo.gl/Ts4c	http://goo.gl/Ts4c
Name	UMU StopThief	Lookout	Lookout	Lookout
URL	http://goo.gl/jtrg	http://goo.gl/5251	http://goo.gl/5251	http://goo.gl/5251

side is that if the GPS has been disabled, you will have nothing to work with.

Tip: GPS based applications work best when you are outdoors.

Samsung Mobile Tracker

Samsung mobiles have been coming equipped with a tracking facility for a while now. The user has to simply enter two mobile numbers of trusted people and when a new SIM is inserted, the buddy numbers automatically get a message which can be used to track down the phone.

Protect your privates

If you have ever spent late nights in the privacy of your bedroom sending lewd S(ex)MS's to your better half, you ought to be really worried right about now. Don't torment yourself, because there are an abundance of options out there to keep yours (and everyone else's) dignity intact.

Data Encryption: Using a password protected encryption on your memory card is the first step towards ensuring that what's meant for your eyes only stays that way even if your mobile is stolen. Recent Symbian S60 devices such as the E series provide an inbuilt encryption facility. Android has 'Tasker' (non market version) and Windows mobile users have 'Mobile Encryption'. Black-

berry users have encryption as a feature in their phones by default and can set a password for their memory card access.

Remote Wipe and Lock: Another means of protecting your data and making sure that all the data is wiped off your phone is by way of using the same tracking software mentioned above to send a command to your phone which would basically wipe all data off your phone. Android users currently running FroYo have the remote wipe feature built in (<http://goo.gl/ICpL>). Some of the featured applications can even lock your phone down and essentially make it a brick preventing the user from even booting up.

This is not advisable though as it will only coerce the robber into paying a 'know-it-all' mobile guru in your local mobile phone repair store to format the phone completely and reinstall the operating system... which is disastrous as far as recovering your mobile is concerned. These actions can again be performed using either an SMS or the web depending on your preference.

Step into the cloud

Ok, last resort! Your mobile has been stolen and that dastardly devil has had

the smarts to go and format your phone disabling all your tracking services in effect. Does that mean you have lost all your contacts, SMS messages, multimedia, applications and data? Absolutely not. The old school option is to perform regular backups of the above using the software that came bundled with your phone, regular being the operative word.

Then again, you could choose to take the route that's got the whole IT world abuzz and allow all the things you care about to be uploaded to the internet. What this would require you to do then is simply buy a phone running the same operating system and an internet connection to get everything you care about back on your new phone just the way it was. These backups are automated and done for you on a regular basis, so you don't ever have to worry about doing it manually.

In hindsight

Looking back at the time you had your beloved in your hands instead of the cheap replacement you had to buy in its place is something most of us can relate to. Simply hoping that you had taken some preventive measures will not

Build your own



If none of the security software featured meet your exact needs and requirements you can consider building an application on your own. Check out the Tech@Work section for information on building mobile applications for a living and you could be laughing all the way to the bank.

magically bring your blissful beauty back into your caring hands. Point being that though smartphones cost that extra rupee or two, when utilised the right way are worth it in the end. The added value that comes in due to applications that are customisable for your needs can help ensure that what's rightfully yours, stays yours.

So step out of the Shire my friend, and embrace technology for what it can make possible instead of going on a wild goose chase (like our friend the Gollum) for a ring that has no tracking system on it! **d**